# Casemiro Replacement Profile

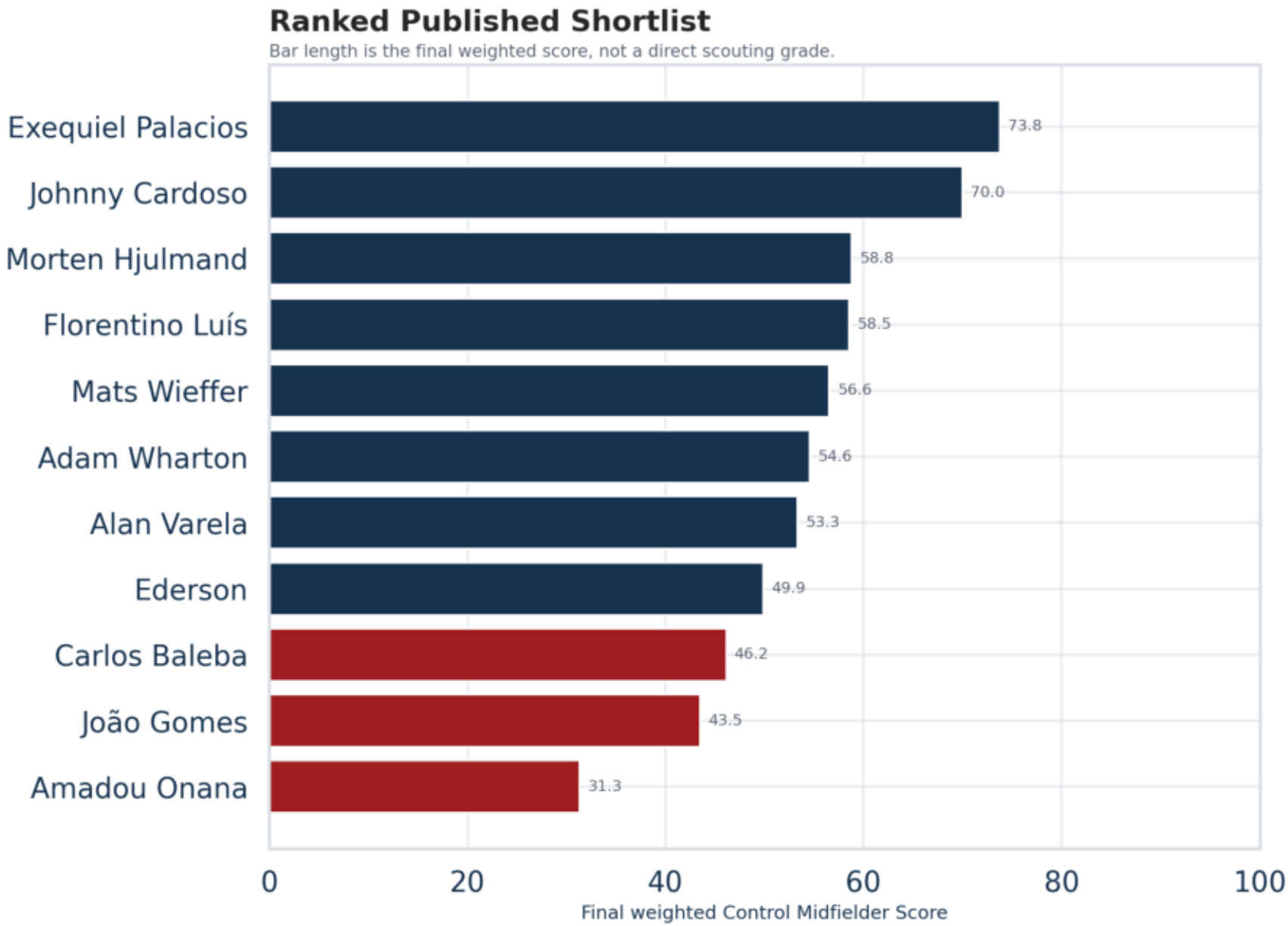
The next signing should not only win duels. It should prevent some of them from happening.

This is a public-data recruitment screen for Manchester United's midfield-control problem.
It is not proprietary scouting data and it is not a signing verdict.

Palacios leads the weighted screen as a possession-control candidate. Cardoso is the cleaner two-axis defensive/security fit. Borderline names should be reviewed through video, tactical role context, league translation, and availability work.

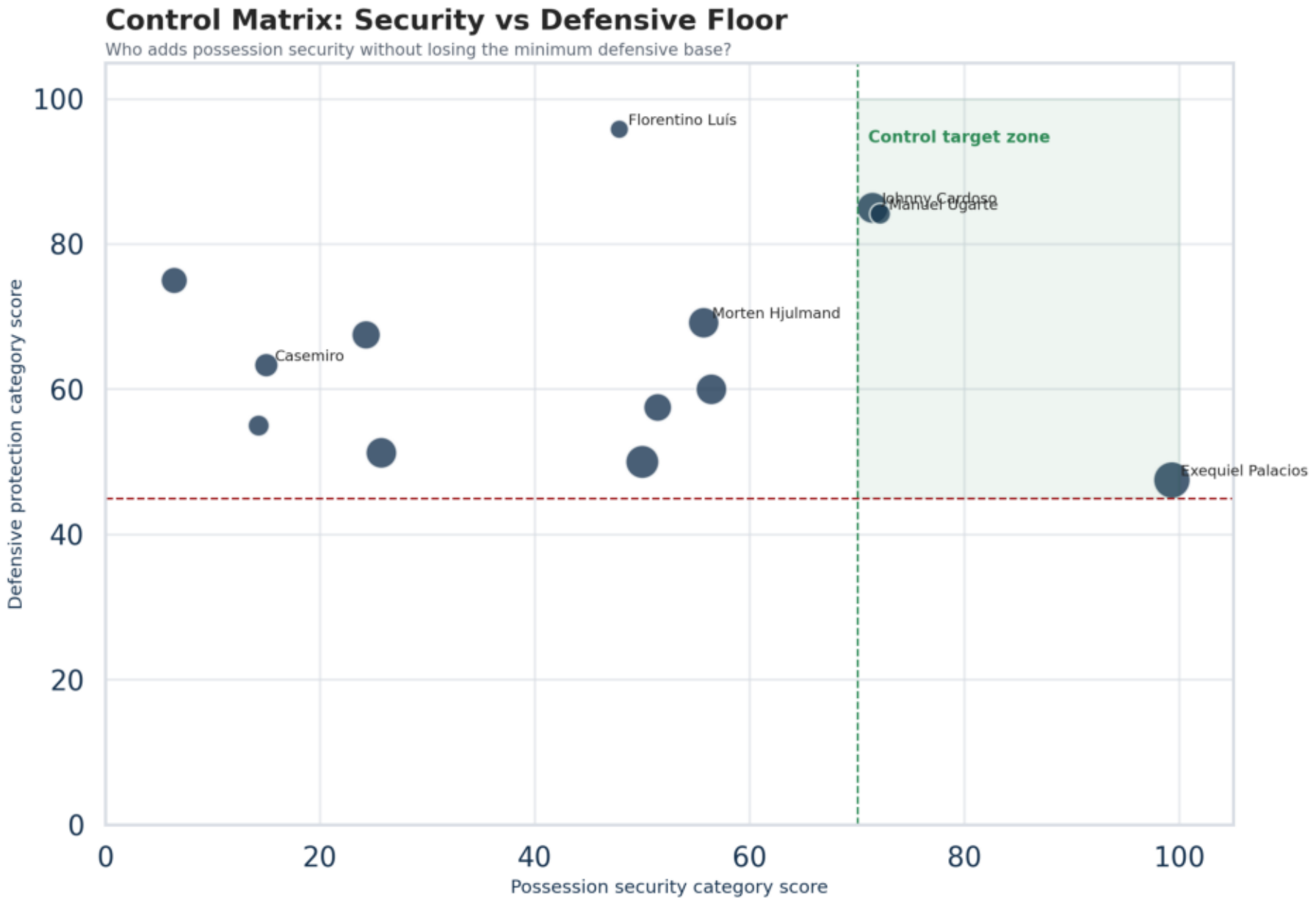
# Ranked Published Shortlist

The bar length is the final weighted score, not a direct scouting grade.



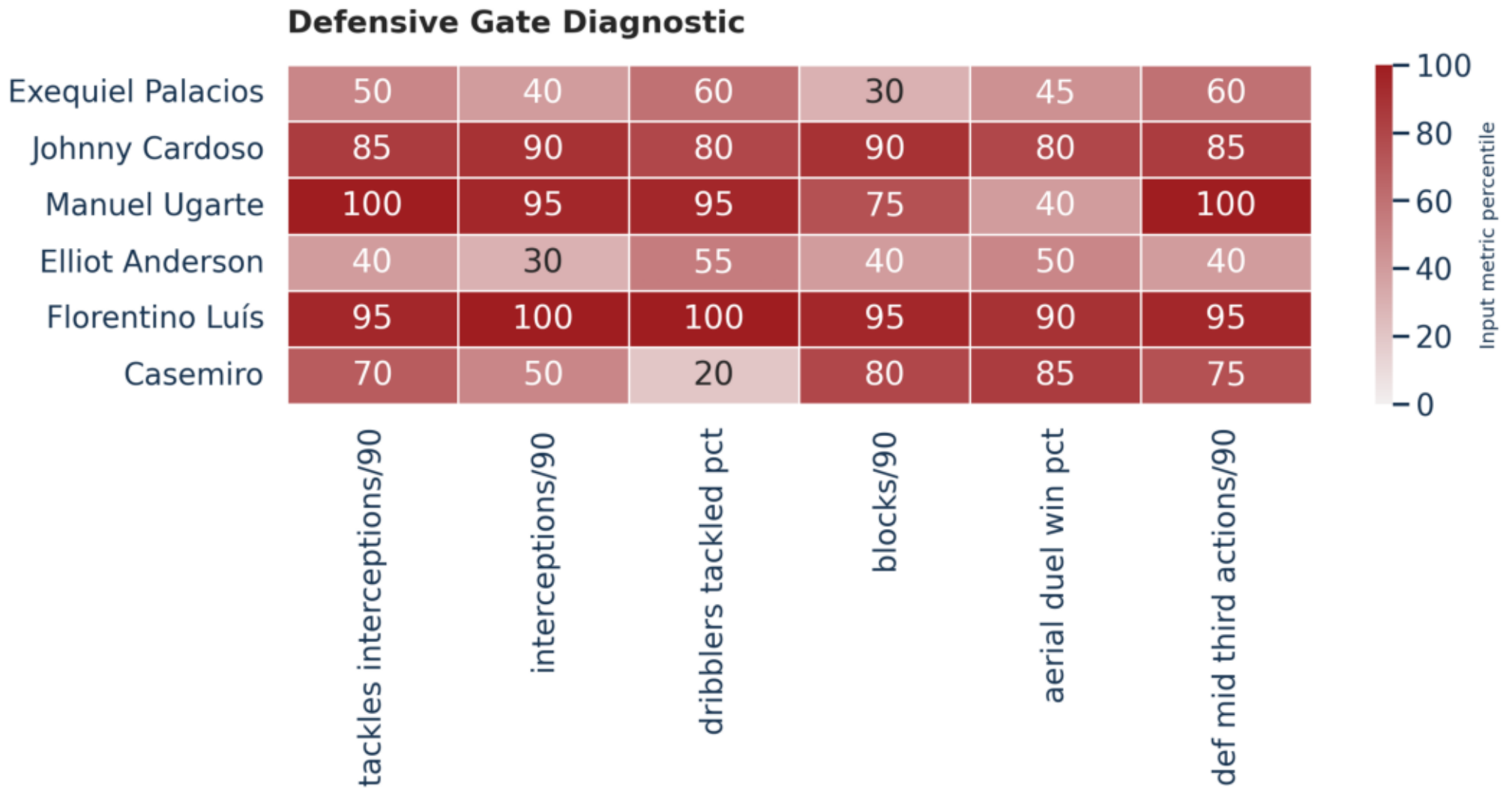
# Control Matrix

This shows the main trade-off: who adds possession security without losing the minimum defensive base?



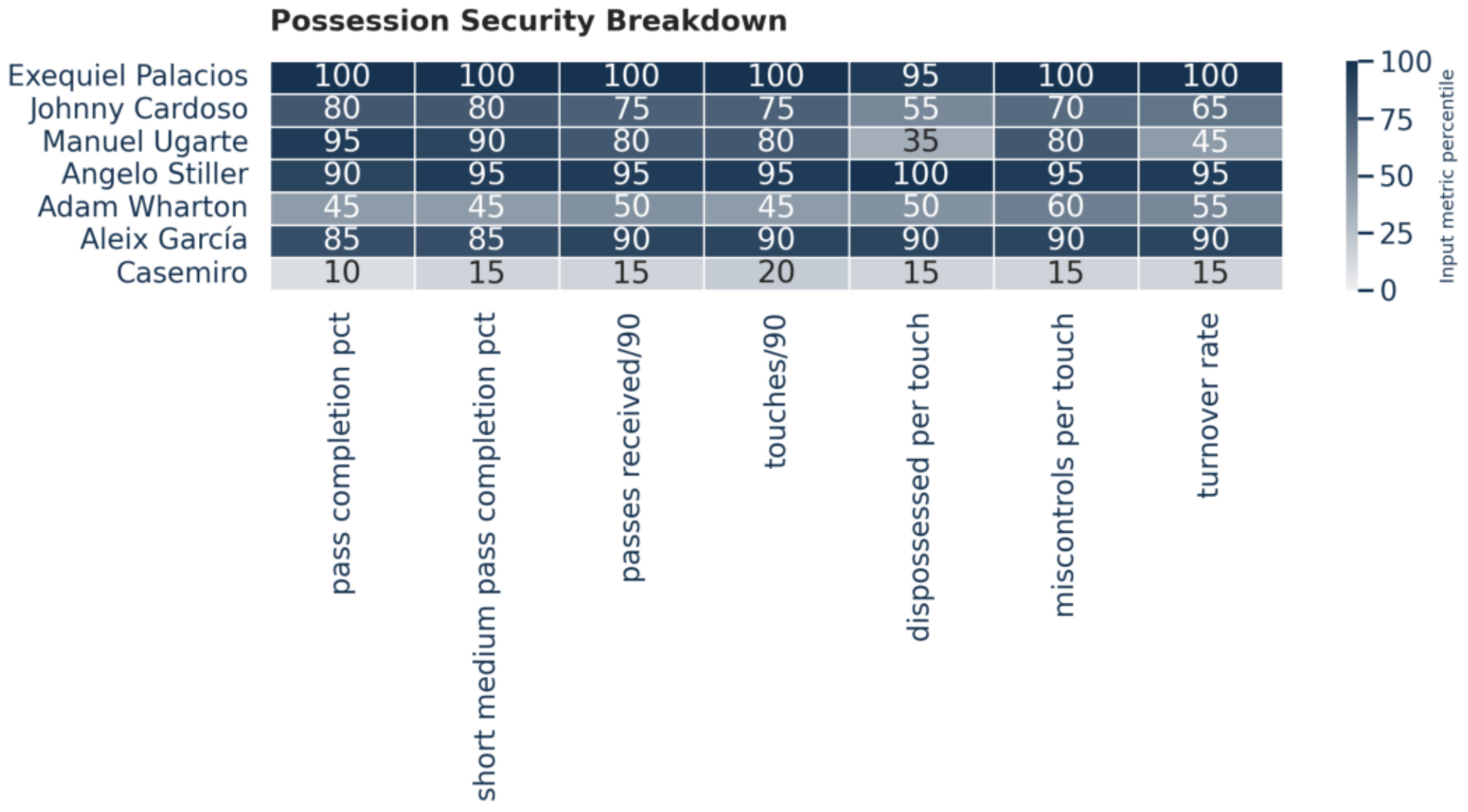
# Defensive Gate Diagnostic

The Palacios-Anderson gap is narrow enough that borderline cases should be video-tested rather than treated as definitive.



# Possession Security Breakdown

This separates safe passers from players who are available, involved, and secure under volume.

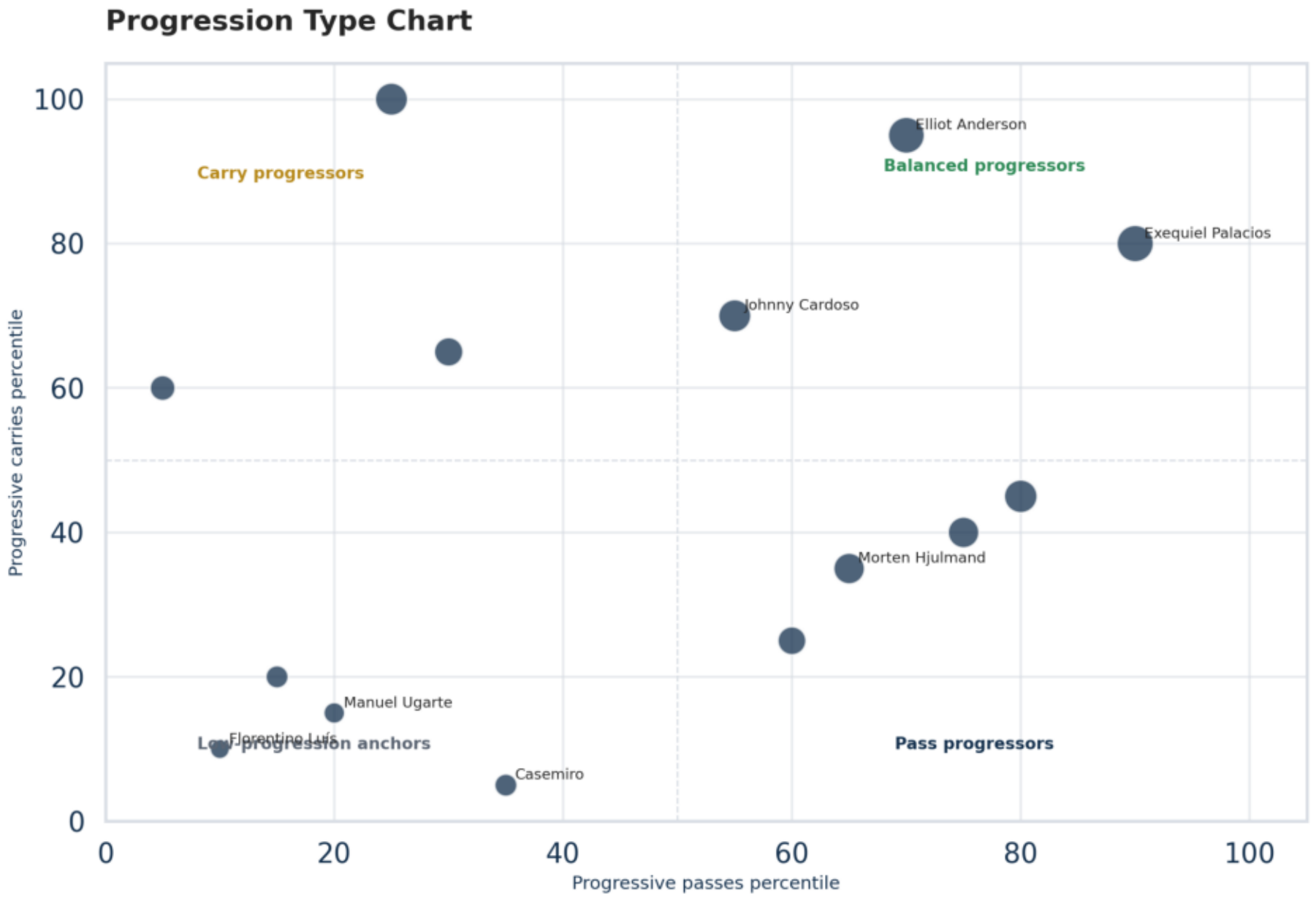


# Transition Chaos Map

United's issue is not only ball-winning; it is the number of unstable moments after possession breaks.

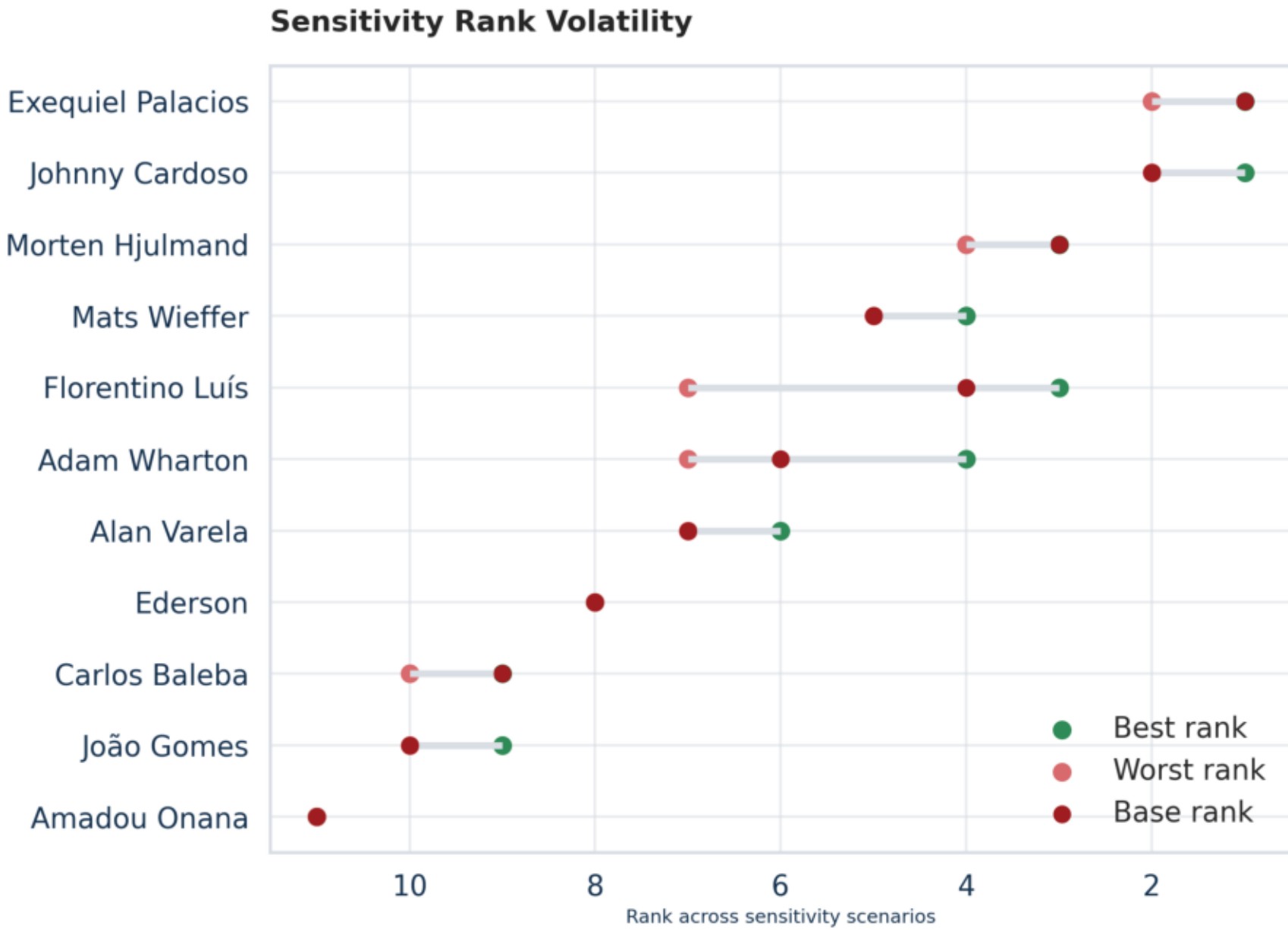
# Progression Type Chart

Progression is not one skill: some players progress through passing, others through carrying.



# Sensitivity Rank Volatility

Lower rank volatility means the player's rank is more stable across weighting scenarios. Average rank should be read alongside volatility, because a player can be stable but still consistently lower-ranked.



# Shortlist Table

The table is constrained to core columns to avoid overflow and keep the PDF readable.

| rank | player | squad | control_midfielde | defensive_protec | transition_contro | possession_secur | progressive_valu | age_availability | gate_margin |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Exequiel Palacios | Bayer Leverkusen | 73.8 | 47.5 | 79.3 | 99.3 | 85.8 | 40.0 | 2.5 |
| 2 | Johnny Cardoso | Atlético Madrid | 70.0 | 85.0 | 63.6 | 71.4 | 57.5 | 42.5 | 40.0 |
| 3 | Morten Hjulmand | Sporting CP | 58.8 | 69.2 | 51.1 | 55.7 | 55.0 | 62.5 | 24.2 |
| 4 | Florentino Luís | Burnley | 58.5 | 95.8 | 59.3 | 47.9 | 8.3 | 35.0 | 50.8 |
| 5 | Mats Wieffer | Brighton & Hove Al | 56.6 | 60.0 | 52.9 | 56.4 | 55.8 | 57.5 | 15.0 |
| 6 | Adam Wharton | Crystal Palace | 54.6 | 50.0 | 61.4 | 50.0 | 67.5 | 32.5 | 5.0 |
| 7 | Alan Varela | Porto | 53.3 | 57.5 | 57.9 | 51.4 | 42.5 | 47.5 | 12.5 |
| 8 | Ederson | Atalanta | 49.9 | 67.5 | 52.9 | 24.3 | 45.0 | 72.5 | 22.5 |
| 9 | Carlos Baleba | Brighton & Hove Al | 46.2 | 51.2 | 50.7 | 25.7 | 55.8 | 66.2 | 6.2 |
| 10 | João Gomes | Wolverhampton Wa | 43.6 | 75.0 | 44.3 | 6.4 | 35.8 | 60.0 | 30.0 |
| 11 | Amadou Onana | Aston Villa | 31.3 | 55.0 | 25.0 | 14.3 | 16.7 | 50.0 | 10.0 |

# Archetype Summary

Archetypes translate the model output into plain-English scouting priorities. Strongest and weakest categories exclude age / availability so the football profile is clearer.

| player | final_score | archetype_label | strongest_football_category | weakest_football_category | gate_margin |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Exequiel Palacios | 73.8 | Control profile | possession_security | defensive_protection | 2.5 |
| Johnny Cardoso | 70.0 | Two-axis defensive/security fit | defensive_protection | progressive_value | 40.0 |
| Manuel Ugarte | 61.7 | Reference profile - current Unite | defensive_protection | progressive_value | 39.2 |
| Elliot Anderson | 61.7 | Removed by defensive gate | progressive_value | defensive_protection | -2.5 |
| Morten Hjulmand | 58.8 | Watchlist / role-context needed | defensive_protection | transition_control | 24.2 |
| Florentino Luís | 58.5 | Defensive-floor anchor | defensive_protection | progressive_value | 50.8 |
| Angelo Stiller | 56.7 | Removed by defensive gate | possession_security | defensive_protection | -36.7 |
| Mats Wieffer | 56.6 | Watchlist / role-context needed | defensive_protection | transition_control | 15.0 |
| Adam Wharton | 54.6 | Watchlist / role-context needed | progressive_value | defensive_protection | 5.0 |
| Hugo Larsson | 54.3 | Removed by defensive gate | possession_security | defensive_protection | -6.2 |
| Alan Varela | 53.3 | Watchlist / role-context needed | transition_control | progressive_value | 12.5 |
| Aleix García | 53.2 | Removed by defensive gate | possession_security | defensive_protection | -38.3 |

# Borderline Watchlist

Players within five points below the defensive gate are moved to video/context review rather than treated as rejected.

| player | squad | control_midfielder_score | defensive_protection | possession_security | gate_margin |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Elliot Anderson | Nottingham Forest | 61.7 | 42.5 | 67.1 | -2.5 |

# Role-Mismatch Watchlist

These players may be useful profiles, but their public-data defensive evidence is further from the minimum filter for this specific brief.

| player | squad | control_midfielder_score | defensive_protection | possession_security | gate_margin |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Angelo Stiller | Stuttgart | 56.7 | 8.3 | 95.0 | -36.7 |
| Hugo Larsson | Eintracht Frankfurt | 54.3 | 38.8 | 66.4 | -6.2 |
| Aleix García | Bayer Leverkusen | 53.2 | 6.7 | 88.6 | -38.3 |
| Samuele Ricci | AC Milan | 49.2 | 28.8 | 70.0 | -16.2 |
| Bruno Guimarães | Newcastle United | 47.9 | 27.5 | 52.1 | -17.5 |
| Youssouf Fofana | AC Milan | 38.2 | 36.2 | 20.7 | -8.8 |

# Sensitivity Summary

Average rank and rank volatility show whether the shortlist depends too heavily on one subjective weighting choice. Lower volatility is better only when the average rank is also strong.

| player | rank_base | rank_defensive_heavy | rank_possession_heavy | average_rank | rank_range | rank_volatility_score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Exequiel Palacios | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1.2 | 1 | 25.0 |
| Johnny Cardoso | 2 | 1 | 2 | 1.8 | 1 | 25.0 |
| Morten Hjulmand | 3 | 4 | 3 | 3.2 | 1 | 25.0 |
| Mats Wieffer | 5 | 5 | 4 | 4.7 | 1 | 25.0 |
| Florentino Luís | 4 | 3 | 5 | 4.8 | 4 | 100.0 |
| Adam Wharton | 6 | 7 | 6 | 5.7 | 3 | 75.0 |
| Alan Varela | 7 | 6 | 7 | 6.7 | 1 | 25.0 |
| Ederson | 8 | 8 | 8 | 8.0 | 0 | 0.0 |
| Carlos Baleba | 9 | 10 | 9 | 9.2 | 1 | 25.0 |
| João Gomes | 10 | 9 | 10 | 9.8 | 1 | 25.0 |
| Amadou Onana | 11 | 11 | 11 | 11.0 | 0 | 0.0 |

# What the Screen Actually Suggests

The screen does not produce one obvious answer. It produces three useful archetypes.

Palacios is the control/progression leader but needs defensive translation and availability review. Cardoso is the cleaner two-axis defensive/security fit. Hjulmand, Florentino Luís, and Wieffer preserve more defensive floor but raise different possession or progression questions.

That is the value of the model: it narrows the next scouting conversation rather than pretending to finish it.